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Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: Top Picks Compared

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Looking for a robot vacuum that balances suction, mopping, and smart navigation without breaking the bank?

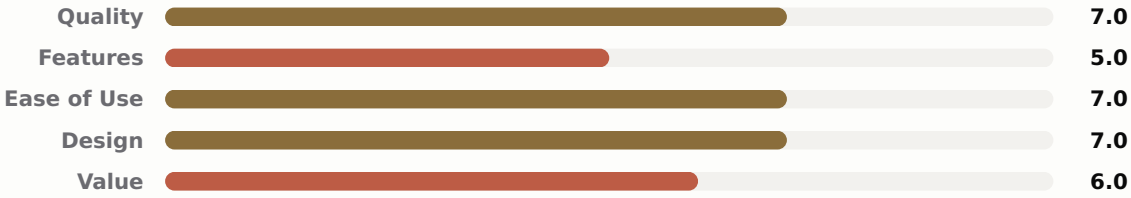
As of October 04, 2026, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo and Shark AI Ultra lines offer compelling options, each with distinct strengths in auto-empty docks, AI obstacle avoidance, and price-to-performance ratios.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

What are the key differences at a glance?

Model	Price (Oct 4 2026)	Original Price	Rating	Primary Function	Auto-Empty Dock
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99	$469.99	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	Vacuum + Mop	Yes
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	$319.99	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	Vacuum + Mop	No
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	$599.00	4.0 (23,990 ratings)	Vacuum only	No

Navigation, mapping, and AI obstacle avoidance

The Roomba 115X series uses iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM (visual simultaneous localization and mapping) and Imprint Smart Mapping. It learns floor plans, labels rooms, and lets you set virtual barriers via the iRobot Home app.

The Shark AI Ultra relies on Shark's IQ Navigation™, which combines a laser sensor with AI-powered object recognition to detect and avoid obstacles such as pet waste, cords, and shoes.

Both support multi-floor mapping and scheduling, but Shark's laser-based approach tends to perform better in low-light conditions, while Roomba's vSLAM excels at distinguishing carpet from hard floors for automatic suction boost.

Suction power, mopping quality, and dock convenience

Suction: Marketing copy indicates the Roomba 115X Combo delivers up to 2,000 Pa of suction—enough for everyday dust and pet hair. The Shark AI Ultra advertises a higher max suction of roughly 2,700 Pa, aimed at deeper carpet cleaning.

Mopping: Only the Roomba 115X Combo models include a vibrating mop pad with a 300 ml water tank and adjustable water flow. The Shark AI Ultra is vacuum-only and does not mop.

Dock convenience: The Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock holds up to 60 days of debris in its sealed bag, reducing empty-bin frequency to roughly once a month for an average household. The Shark AI Ultra uses a standard base station that requires manual emptying after each cleaning cycle.

Which should you choose?

- **Best all-rounder (vacuum + mop + auto-empty):** iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock – great for homes with mixed flooring and pets who want hands-free emptying.
- **Budget-friendly mopping option:** iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) – same cleaning performance at a lower price if you don't mind emptying the bin yourself.
- **Strongest suction, laser navigation:** Shark AI Ultra – ideal for carpet-heavy spaces and low-light rooms where laser-based obstacle avoidance shines.

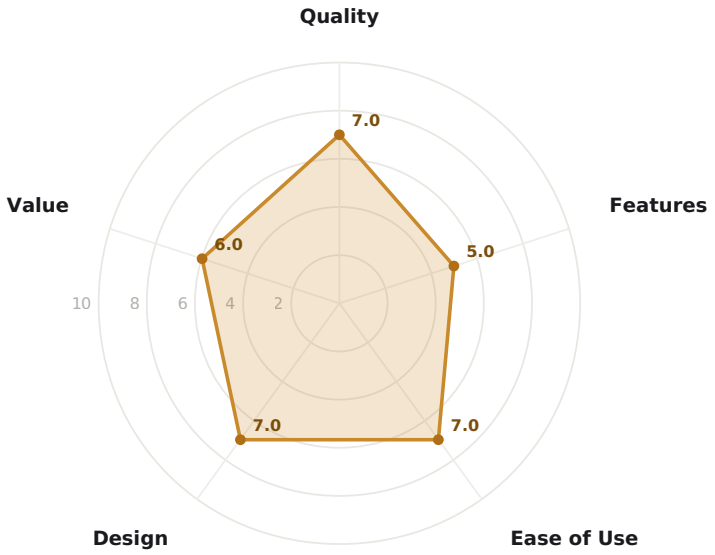
Ready to upgrade your cleaning routine?

Click the links above to see current prices, read more user reviews, and make your purchase. If you buy through our affiliate links, we may earn a small commission at no extra cost to you—helping us keep delivering unbiased guides like this one.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.